

How to Develop God's Agape Love in You

Open to John 17. That is just the starting point.

About three weeks ago I received some instructions, but I received them unusually. If you had asked me the exact moment I received them, I could hardly tell you. But I can tell you exactly what I saw and what He told me during the period of time He was giving them to me.

They concern the next realm He is calling me to walk in. They also concern anybody who can hear it. It may take years and years of getting the presence of God to manifest in its fullness in any service you conduct for God, whatever your calling is. It does not matter whether it is the calling of the believer or the fivefold ministry.

Since the day He showed me this about a month ago, He has not quit visiting me with it. I know He is going to keep on until I do the things necessary to complete it.

Those of you who have been hanging around since last February know I have been caught between something. I have been caught between realms, right in the middle, trying to enter into the next one. I would get in a service like this one, or the one coming up pretty soon, and the Holy Ghost would begin to move on me with the presence of God. I would end up weeping.

Finally I got where I could hold the line and not weep so hard that I could not finish conducting the service. It was at that time we found out that part of that anointing would go onto other people. It was like last Sunday. I know we blazed through here. I think the front was filled a couple of times, but the one I remember was God healing so strongly, healing one person after another.

I have been seeking Him to find out how to enter the next realm, how to get through this one and into that one. To my surprise, I have been telling you all along what I had been doing, how He led me into worship. "Ordered" is not exactly the right word. Directed, led me, that is probably better, since He does not push or drag. The Holy Ghost came to guide you into all truth.

If I do not want to go, then I can die powerless. That is a very simple option. Amen. You can die without fulfilling His plan, and die without even finding it.

For twenty-one days it seemed like the devil knew something was up. He battled me like a crazy man: my emotions, my body, everything. My body fought me like crazy. My emotions fought. He battled me like there was something he did not want me to find out.

Well, it is too bad I slipped past him.

After twenty-one or twenty-two days, I kind of lost track of time, He came and touched me with this Scripture. I did not even know what the touch was for until a couple of months later.

We finally found in John 17, in the prayer Jesus prayed for you and me, that Him in us, us in Them, the Father in Jesus, and Jesus in us, all means we have been made perfect in one. The One we have been perfected in is Jesus Christ.

Just like Adam went away and received our imperfection, Jesus went away and received us unto Himself. In Him we were perfected.

All those statements we have been studying about His glory, "My glory I give unto you," showed us that He was talking about the standing He held with His Father. Right now a glorified human being is sitting at the Father's right hand as Head of the Church.

That whole standing He had with His Father as the firstborn, He came and received you and me into it. "My glory," this place I hold with My Father as His firstborn, "I give unto you."

He said, "I go away and procure this same place for you, and I will come again and receive you unto Myself, that where I am as a Son of God, I will receive you and you may walk there also."

Numerically, I do not know my rebirth. I do not know what number it was in the scheme of things since Adam to become a son of God and be born again. But I know when I get there, Jesus can tell me exactly what number I was.

He said, "My glory I give unto you." That is the standing He held with His Father as the firstborn. The difference between Him and you is that He is also deity. He is deity and humanity. You are humanity. You cannot create a God. God has always been and always will be. Jesus is deity and humanity, and we are part of one with Him in His humanity.

Hallelujah.

To understand this is when you are really going to mess things up around here. To understand it is when you are really going to mess your city up. To understand it is to receive more of God than you can imagine.

In February, I did not know the importance of that touch. Up to that point, once in a great while when He was moving supernaturally one way or another, I would enter into what I just labeled intercession a little bit. I would be taken out sometimes and have the privilege of standing in the gap and entering into a little intercession.

But I had never spent a solid nine hours, the last six of them weeping so hard I could hardly stop long enough to catch my breath.

Later, when I looked back, the nearest I could describe it was a child you had corrected and then told, "Dry your tears now." They try, but they cannot. They gasp and try to stop, but the tears keep coming.

I kept thinking, "What is wrong with me? Is this me?" I would try to stop, and that is what I would get, like a child trying to dry his tears. I could hardly stop, so I called for prayer. I got Gary, and I could hardly talk to him. I tried to call home and could hardly talk to them. I would try to say something, cry for a minute or so, and then try to say something again.

I found out that the One who touched me was my Father.

Being a rogue, explorer kind of guy, God had arrested me when I made it to Oregon. I was heading for Alaska and beyond. I wanted to go where there were no people. He arrested me, turned me back around, and sent me where there are people.

Concerning ministry, I said, "God, I want all You have: all the power and glory. There is just one thing. I want it yesterday."

Then I began to find out who He is. At this point He began to uncloak Himself to me in what I now understand as the transition from God to God my Father.

From this realm on, as God my Father, He peeled Himself back only to the thinness of an onion peel, so thin you could see light on the other side of it. That was not much, but that was all the information He would give me about Himself at one time as God the Father.

Just that one moment, my first look at how much He really loves people, caused nine hours of weeping. It also released a gift that belongs to the healing family and has been able to reach down and destroy roots and strongholds in people's lives.

Now I know for sure that the gifts of healings are plural, because they cover much more than the physical anatomy God wants to heal. He wants the equivalent of a man's spirit jumping out of a wheelchair. He wants to be that strong toward us in waves of glory and power.

Just one look through His eyes for a minute, one touch of the compassion He has, caused a healing gift to begin to manifest with strength. Crowds started breaking down, crying and weeping, with a stillness and healing taking place. That was just from the first touch of His compassion and seeing people through the Father's eyes a little bit.

Just a little bit. I could hardly take it.

Here I wanted all God had yesterday, and I could not take a ten-second look at Him without it messing me up for six months.

I found the verse He touched me with. John 17:23 says:

I in them, and thou in me, that they may be made perfect in one;
and that the world may know that thou hast sent me, and hast loved them, as thou hast loved me.

"I in them, Father, and You in Me. Because You are in Me, I am in them, that we all might be made perfect in one."

Again, who was the One we were made perfect in? Jesus Christ. The same way Adam made us imperfect in one, Jesus came and gave us a standing. He made us perfect in Him, in one. Because we are in Him, we are also in the Father, and the Father is in Him. We are all made perfect in one.

Then comes this part: "That the world may know that Thou hast sent Me, and hast loved them, as Thou hast loved Me."

Can you imagine being touched for one moment with the same love the Father loved Jesus with, and having Him touch you with that? Can you imagine feeling the same love He has for Jesus for even a moment?

The first thing it did was forever change the way I prayed for people, mostly in the effectiveness I prayed with.

After getting back to the church from Cleveland, where I had been for six weeks, Brad had a genuine heart attack while driving down the road, and God healed him over the phone. The effectiveness I was able to pray with came because I got a good look through God's eyes.

Hallelujah.

Something had definitely happened when I looked at people through His eyes for a moment.

Since that touch, I knew He had done something, but I have been locked between two realms, trying to get through this one and into the next one. I have mentioned that several times. I have been rendered almost useless and nearly had to be taken out of a service. You have to understand, I am used to ministry line upon line, the gifts coming, and the service ending. I was not used to that kind of thing.

When that effectiveness to pray for other people came, it was not three or four months into it before I was in my office praying and waiting on God. In my spirit, I began to hear crowd noises. The next thing I knew, I could see myself with my hands up, and each hand was stuffed full of requests.

The crowd noises I heard were excited people who had just had their prayers answered. Holding all those prayer requests up, I naturally assumed those excited people were people we had somehow prayed for from a distance, and they had received the answers to their requests.

God started coming, so I definitely knew something was happening.

At that time He gave me the mystery of Paul's aprons and those kinds of things. They were avenues of compassion. God was more able to follow that man's clothing from town to town and do miracles than He could follow most men's physical presence. The article of clothing linked people with a compassion and faith in God that caused them to be healed just from running into that man's clothing.

Most people do not have that kind of power in their physical presence. They reduce God to following men's clothing.

So I knew God wanted to heal from a distance. I knew that all the people we ministered to by mail had requests that could be collected up and laid before God. So many would receive their answers that it caused the roar of a crowd behind me, excited people crying, "Something is happening!"

What are we going to do with verses that say all things are possible to him that believeth, and nothing shall be impossible to you?

I finally got my marching orders. I think it started happening about a month ago, but it happened in parts. Something would pass through my spirit, and I would try to collect myself enough to understand what it was. When it got clear enough to articulate, I articulated some to Gary, some to Tim, and some of our boys who are walking hungry enough that they want to step into the presence of God and everything He has.

This time, I was worshiping God with my hands up, just like I had been standing with all those needs in my hands. My hands were up, and I was standing in front of a large auditorium full of people. The glory of God was moving so strongly they could not stand up. Miracles were happening. The presence was so strong that you could not just walk into it and stand there. People would walk into the place and start falling down.

As I saw this with my hands up, He said, "Now this is what I want you to do."

Why would He show me that and then tell me what to do right after it if it did not have to do with that kind of presence? What can get God to come like that?

Mine is a calling. I am supposed to stand in front of people and help perfect them. That is calling material. I do not know what else your calling is, but I do know that the presence I saw belongs to every believer. In the equipping of my calling, it took on a slightly different slant or manifestation.

He told me, "This is how I want you to spend your time in the closet now."

He gave me a specific amount of time again to enter into private worship. That does not mean I would not pray in tongues and couple things together. That does not mean I do not speak the Word. I will pray in tongues and speak the Word. During this season, I will pray in tongues while going back and forth here and there, locked up for a couple extra hours, and I can speak His Word. But the time He gave me is time when I am lost in worship.

There is no use giving you the amount of time. Yours would not be the same as mine. Besides, only those who are hungry will do this, and you will start with a certain amount. It will not be what He gave me.

I have been twenty-nine years coming here. I say to one man, "Go," and he goes. He comes, and they create this place for me and guard it where I can step into it. For forty days, forty times a month, year after year, I delivered this gospel, preached, got on planes overseas and back. Thirty years.

He found me faithful in that. Disease and sickness could not stop me from walking in. I never missed a single service that I was scheduled to preach because of sickness in thirty years.

Hallelujah.

Sometimes when I started for the meeting, I did not think I was going to make it, but He always came. Sometimes I would preach, and the moment I prayed to open the service, everything would lift off me. Then, when the service was over, it would come back. I fought those kinds of wars.

Now He has created this place for me, and I get to enter into it. He told me to worship Him a certain amount of time. The last time He said to do something like that, all kinds of fireworks began: the anointing of the believer and all kinds of things, until finally last February God actually came and touched my spirit with His love.

Now stay close. I finally understand.

When you and I were born again, we were translated out of darkness and into the kingdom of His dear Son. We went from a sin nature to a new nature.

We did not come into the kingdom of God automatically knowing everything. But we came in with a capacity to be taught, a capacity to understand spiritual things, and to literally discern spiritual things. We did not know everything about God when we came in, but we came in with a nature that could discern and understand everything God could reveal to us about Himself.

For years I had the revelation gift building me to this place, and I understood it. That revelation gift is praying in tongues. Praying in tongues is what finally put the worship limb on, the fasting limb on, and every other limb we are enjoying. It is bringing us to tremendous balance.

As we have taught many times, praying in tongues is a revelation gift. A student does not automatically know what his professor knows. The knowledge has to be transferred from the professor to the student.

Yet when you decide to pray that one little hour a day in tongues, even while going about your business, that is the day you walk into the classroom of the Holy Spirit. The fine-dressed Gentleman at the chalkboard is none other than He whom Jesus said has come to guide you into all truth. He will receive of Mine and show it unto you.

Because you have His nature, the nature of God born again, you can understand everything He wants to teach you. You can discern every move of the Spirit He wants you to understand. You can literally receive, discern, and understand the revelation of God as your Father.

When you were born again, you received the capacity to understand Him. But when you pray in tongues, the revelation of all those things comes. Then comes the time for you to appropriate what He is trying to teach you, such as His glory, His power, and His love.

Trust me when I say that when you were born again, you did not come into the kingdom knowing everything in your spirit. But you did change nature, and now you have the capacity to understand anything about God the Holy Spirit is free to teach you. You can discern spiritual things.

Go to 1 Corinthians 2:11. Put a marker in Romans 8. When we get there, we will be in verse 15.

Paul is saying the same thing in 1 Corinthians 2 as he says in Romans 8. One was to the Corinthian church, and one was to the Jews in the Roman church. Follow it closely.

1 Corinthians 2:11 says:

For what man knoweth the things of a man, save the spirit of man which is in him?

Notice that is a lowercase s, referring to the human spirit, not the Holy Spirit. Then it says:

Even so the things of God knoweth no man, but the Spirit of God.

The second "Spirit" is uppercase in many translations, but I believe it should be lowercase because Paul did not change the subject in this verse. He is still talking about your human spirit.

What man knows the things of man except the spirit of man in him? Even so, the things of God can no man know except by the spirit of God, by the new nature and born-again spirit he received when he was born again.

We always thought that was the Holy Spirit. Not so.

When he said, "What man knoweth the things of a man," he meant spiritually dead man. He had no way of knowing anything outside of being spiritually dead. That is why Paul said, "I had not known lust, except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet." He was a spiritually dead man confined to a spiritually dead nature, with no way to know anything outside that nature.

Romans 7 gives the dilemma that put him into: "The good I would do, I cannot; and the evil I refuse to do, I always end up doing. Therefore it is no longer I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me."

With his mind, he received the commandment of God and tried to walk in it. But he could not because there was a nature of sin in him that took him captive and caused him to sin time after time.

There is no way a spiritually dead man, born that way, can know anything outside that nature, because the nature is what you are. It is what makes you what you are.

But now, the same way the man knew the things of death, he receives a new nature and can understand the things of God because it lets him on the inside of God.

Look at verse 12:

Now we have received, not the spirit of the world, but the spirit which is of God; that we might know the things that are freely given to us of God.

Thank God, we did not receive the spirit of the world. We received the spirit which is of God. I believe the lower case s is correct there, talking about the human spirit being born again.

How can we know the things freely given to us by God now? Because we received the new nature, the spirit that is from God. We did not receive the spirit that is of this world, the one the first man Adam gave us. We have the born-again spirit now, the spirit that is of God.

Paul says the same thing in Romans 8:15:

For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear; but ye have received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father.

In Corinthians he said, "We received not the spirit that is of this world." Here he calls it "the spirit of bondage again to fear." If we have not received that one, what one did we receive? The spirit of adoption whereby we cry, "Abba, Father."

Everybody says the Spirit of adoption is the Holy Spirit because it has an uppercase S. But in Corinthians, the same thought has a lowercase s. The Spirit of adoption is not the Holy Spirit. He does not need to be adopted.

We received not the spirit of bondage again to fear, the one Adam gave us, the one that could not keep the commandments of God. Every time God gave a commandment, it brought bondage and fear because we were spiritually dead and could not keep it.

The one we received is the born-again spirit that has been adopted by God, that we might know the things freely given to us of God.

Then His Spirit, the Holy Spirit, bears witness with our spirit that we are the sons of God. Then Paul goes on into our inheritance: if sons, then heirs of God; and if heirs, then joint-heirs with Jesus.

In Corinthians he simply said that we can know all about the inheritance and everything freely given to us of God. But both passages are saying exactly the same thing.

I have been born again. Now I can understand all things freely given to me by God.

More than that, He sent me a Teacher to teach my nature, the Holy Spirit. More than that, He brought a supernatural language to pray for me for the things He wants me to understand and discern, the things freely given to me by God.

When I was born again, not only did I receive a capacity to discern and understand spiritual things, not only how to discern and operate in His power and the gifts of the Spirit, but I also had certain attributes my spirit was born into and has a capacity to develop.

Can I tell you one of those things? Yes, I can.

Have you ever heard the word agape?

When I was born again and received the nature of God, created in that nature, maybe in infancy stages but wanting to grow up, was the nature of God which is love. You can imprison that just as you can imprison your born-again spirit under false doctrines, until it never gets strong enough to conquer your soul, habits, and other things.

"Do you mean we have a capacity for the love of God?"

Yes, sir. That capacity was born into us, created into us when God gave us His nature. I have agape in my spirit, and it has the capacity to be developed. It is in there. Yet it can lie so dormant and undeveloped that people spend their whole lives hating other people, in strife and division, causing trouble, because they never allowed that attribute of their spirit to develop enough to influence their walk in the love of God.

What part of me did He touch? He reached down and touched the part of my spirit, in its nature, that has agape and the capacity to grow. He touched the part of my spirit that could understand that love. He touched it, and brought that part of my spirit forth a little bit. Not a whole lot, because I could not take a whole lot right then, but just enough for a tangible presence and fellowship with my Father to begin to develop.

What did we call that tangible presence? We called it the anointing of the believer, did we not? You raise your hands, and your Father comes into the room with you in fellowship. Everything He was and is in that tangible presence.

The fisherman on the Amazon and others learned this. He worshiped God for thirty-six days straight. For six months, he ate just enough to stay alive. Then at the end, he went thirty-six days worshipping God around the clock, day and night, and that man was caught up around the throne room of God where the creatures were worshipping God.

When I first started going, he was listening to me. This last time I went, I was listening to him. "Tell me more about this." We were stifled through a language barrier, but I was starting to catch on.

My God, what part of me does worship develop? What attribute do I possess in my spirit? What capacity does my born-again human spirit have that God wants to develop, that warrants Him coming with His glory and tangible presence and doing things for human beings beyond what we have ever seen before in His glory and power?

What makes you think that if your spirit developed to a whole gallon jug in its capacity to hold the love of God, you would not turn Him loose on massive auditoriums to mess them up in royal style?

I said, "Father, are You telling me that the part of my spirit worship develops, by You continually fellowshiping with me hour after hour, is Your agape? My capacity for Your love, everything You are toward humanity, all of that love, that attribute that became part of my nature, can be developed? Are You telling me worship develops it?"

What was Jesus moved by when He healed all their infirmities? Compassion. The last part of compassion is passion. It was His passion.

Scripture says, "As he is, so are we in this world." For this reason, I can have great boldness in the day of judgment, because I know I can be as Him in this world. I can hasten toward judgment.

For years God has been trying to get something over to me about our life in heaven and our life here. He said one of the things that disrupts men most is the fear that lingers about stepping over. They are afraid to do this and afraid to do that. They are afraid of lack.

Perfect love casts out that kind of fear, because that kind of fear has torment.

We do not look at stepping out of this body and stepping into the most glorious experience imaginable to mankind that way, because of the barrier of the senses. If God had any trouble understanding anything about us, it would be our fear of crossing that barrier.

Because of it, we hold back. We are afraid to go here, afraid to go there, afraid of other lands and different things. Why? Because we are not able to approach that barrier that crosses us over and say, "My God, that is just part of my life. This is the greatest thing there is. That is when everything really begins, and I have the opportunity to be found faithful now."

There is something that needs to be developed there that people do not have much of yet: the loss of that kind of fear.

Because He is, so are we in this world. Perfect love casts out fear. Fear has torment, and he who has torment has not been perfected in that love. There is a perfecting He wants to do in that love.

I could never have seen it if He had not put me on the Born-Again Trail and handed the worship key to me on a golden platter. You cannot suspend your spirit in the presence of God hour after hour without developing the attribute of love. The more He comes and fellowships in it, the stronger it becomes, and the more tangible His presence becomes.

In what? In love.

Hallelujah.

When God ordered me into the closet, we really did not know where we were walking. I was walking in a place with God where He would come and go. I am talking about tangible presence. He would come and go, mostly in a service.

It was easy at first. Then God retreated back on the other side of the flesh, where I was really walking. At first He would come, and I would say, "Yes, worship, worship!" But then there was this barrier of flesh between us, and He went back over there, because that was where we were really walking.

I kept worshiping. He would come over and visit me a little bit, then have to go back where I was holding Him. I would worship, and He would come back over, then have to go back where I was holding Him. Each time, month after month, going back was not as far away.

All the books said I was not in the Spirit when I could not feel it. Quite the contrary. The less you could feel meant the more flesh was in the way.

All heaven, Michael, Gabriel, everybody, was cheering when God would retreat back to the other side of the flesh and you would not even lose a sentence of worship, even though every antagonistic feeling of flesh was saying, "You are wasting your time in here. My lawn grew an inch in an hour. I should have been mowing it. I can think of a million things I need to do rather than spend this time saying this over and over."

Then the devil tries to get close enough to scream at you in your worship closet: "Where is your faithful God? You are in there worshiping Him hour after hour, and there are things you have been believing for that are not happening."

You are in there telling Him how faithful He is, and the devil goes on. You just keep going. Heaven is rejoicing. God is receiving it even more because now the flesh, the devil, and everything are stacked against your worship, and you will not stop.

That is when agape starts developing.

I thought He just came because He liked me so well and wanted fellowship. But the love in me developed and developed until it got big enough for Him to walk in it all the time.

As He is, so are we in this world. Perfect love casts out fear. Fear has torment, and he who has torment has not been perfected in love.

So now I know what to do.

"How about the Word and praying in tongues and all that?"

Do you think He requires less of that from me just because He gave me another key?

Hallelujah.

No wonder I could feel the baptism of my senses. No wonder I could feel His presence with my sense man.

Near the end of that seeking time, after the devil had battled me for twenty-one or twenty-two days, and after I wept, I stayed in there for a while longer. I would walk around with my hands up, and all of a sudden His glory or something came on me. My hands were up, and the power pushed me back to about a forty-five-degree angle.

I was leaning back there thinking, "What is this?" Then I thought, "You are just weak, and your hands pulled you over."

So I said, "Forgive me my folly." I put my hands down by my side and said, "I really love You. I worship You." I went right back to a forty-five-degree angle. It was pushing on me. I had to step back.

I got the biggest kick out of Gary's friend, the truck driver, when he came. He was sitting over here, and I called him out. I said, "Get out here."

I stepped up to pray for him, raised my hands, and he started going back. He got back quite a ways.

I said, "What are you doing?"

He said, "Something is pushing on me."

It was. You could tangibly see him being pushed back real hard.

Can you imagine lifting your hands in the presence of a sinner and saying, "I love You, Father"? Do you think they cannot feel Him come in? Do you think He will not do things for them?

In no uncertain terms, He made me know that the more I understand His love, out of that attribute He gave me to understand it with, the more needs are going to be met, because I am going to understand His passions toward them.

Bronc and the others hit that flesh and thought they were going to die. Bronc showed me his office. He was agonizing hour after hour, coughing up dry dust. His worship felt like little puffs of powder. "God, I love You." Dry. He felt like a mummy that had been unwrapped in an ancient tomb somewhere.

But all of them stayed in. The day came when they walked where they had never walked before, and you could not shut them up with a two-by-four. They called me, and I patiently listened because I had already been through it.

Hallelujah.

Some of you are going to be wise enough to get it.

Amen.

Stand up and raise your hands.